DIGITAL LITERACY: Project Report

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INTRODUCTION

Digital literacy is a vital skill in our technology-driven world, enabling individuals to use devices, online platforms, and communication tools effectively and responsibly. This project was undertaken as a Student Digital Ambassador for the Digital Literacy course to develop practical digital skills required for professional and academic success.

The primary objective was to create resources that assist peers in understanding digital awareness, professional online presence, safe communication, and cyber security. The project is divided into five tasks encompassing infographic creation, digital portfolio development, coding and collaboration platforms, professional communication, and cybercrime awareness. Completing these tasks significantly enhanced my understanding of responsible technology use and the necessity of maintaining a positive digital identity.

TASK 1 - DIGITAL LITERACY INFOGRAPHIC

- **Objective:** To design a one-page digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva.
- **Description:** The infographic explained the concept of digital literacy and highlighted its importance for students in their daily and academic lives. It covered essential topics such as useful digital tools, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Visual elements, including icons, color blocks, and distinct headings, were utilized to present the information in a clear and engaging manner.
- **Outcome:** Designing the infographic demonstrated how complex information can be simplified through visual communication. While selecting and organizing the most important points onto a single page was challenging, the task successfully improved my creativity and awareness of essential digital skills.

TASK 2 - STUDENT DIGITAL PORTFOLIO

- **Objective:** To develop a professional digital portfolio by creating profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.
- **Description:** GitHub was set up to showcase technical work and projects, including the repository for this digital literacy project. A LinkedIn profile was established to build a professional identity and display educational details, which will aid in networking with alumni and industry professionals. Additionally, Kaggle was selected as a platform to explore data science competitions and resources.
- **Outcome:** Each platform serves a unique purpose in building a robust online presence. This task emphasized the importance of maintaining a professional digital identity from the beginning of college and provided insight into how institutions and employers evaluate candidates online. These profiles will be continuously updated over the next four years with achievements, certifications, and projects.

TASK 3 - CODING & COLLABORATION PLATFORMS

- **Objective:** To explore online coding practice platforms and cloud-based collaboration tools.
- **Description:** A beginner-level coding challenge was completed on HackerRank, providing valuable experience with automated evaluation systems and online programming environments. Furthermore, a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz consisting of five questions related to safe internet use was created using Google Forms. The responses were automatically recorded in a linked Google Sheet, demonstrating how cloud tools enable efficient collaboration and data collection.
- **Outcome:** This task helped in understanding how coding platforms support skill development through practice and automated feedback. It enhanced my technical confidence and familiarity with cloud platforms that are highly useful for academic and industry activities like surveys, assignments, and group projects.

TASK 4 - PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION & SOCIAL MEDIA ETIQUETTE

- **Objective:** To develop professional communication skills and promote responsible online behaviour.
- **Description:** Two formal emails were drafted: one requesting an assignment deadline extension from a professor, and another expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. Both drafts adhered strictly to proper etiquette, featuring clear subject

lines, a structured format, a respectful tone, and a formal sign-off. Additionally, a checklist of social media "Do's and Don'ts" was created for students.

- **Outcome:** The task highlighted the critical importance of professionalism in emails and social media interactions. It served as a reminder that poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings, reputational damage, or missed opportunities.

TASK 5 - CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY

- **Objective:** To prepare a case study on phishing attacks alongside a prevention checklist.
- **Description:** The case study detailed phishing—a cybercrime where attackers impersonate trusted organizations to steal sensitive information like OTPs, passwords, or banking details. It explained how these attacks occur and their severe consequences, such as identity theft and financial loss, emphasizing that students are frequent targets due to their heavy use of digital payments and online services. The prevention checklist provided practical safety tips for online communication and UPI transactions.
- **Outcome:** Researching cybercrime was eye-opening, revealing how easily cybercriminals exploit human trust. As a direct result of this task, I will be significantly more cautious about sharing personal information online and clicking unknown links.

CONCLUSION

This project provided highly valuable insights into responsible technology use and digital literacy. It facilitated the development of core skills related to professional communication, online safety, digital collaboration tools, and the establishment of a strong online presence. Each task contributed to a broader understanding of how digital technologies can be leveraged productively for career and academic growth. The hands-on experience of creating real awareness materials and digital resources was highly beneficial, ultimately strengthening my confidence in navigating the digital world effectively and safely.

REFERENCES

- **Canva** - https://www.canva.com
- **GitHub** - https://github.com

- **LinkedIn** - https://www.linkedin.com
- **HackerRank** - https://www.hackerrank.com
- **Google Forms** - https://forms.google.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal** - Noted for the fact that digital literacy is crucial for combating hoaxes and protecting oneself.